

Vibe Appliance — Restore Runbook

Get back a file, a module, or the whole appliance. Print this; keep it with the Recovery Kit.

Vibe Appliance setup guide · built 2026-08-31 · adapted from Vibe-Backup docs/restore-runbook.md · KisaesDevLab/Vibe-Appliance

Print this document now and keep it with the printed Recovery Kit. The tier that matters most (T2) is for the day the appliance is dead, encrypted, or stolen — the day you cannot open the console this PDF is served from. A restore runbook that only exists on the machine being restored is not a runbook.

How to use this

Three tiers. Work top-down; use the smallest tier that fixes the problem. T0 and T1 happen in the Vibe Backup app (admin console → **Apps** → **Vibe Backup** → its card link); T2 needs only the printed kit and a fresh machine.

T0 — A file

Vibe Backup → **Restore** → choose the backup date → enter or browse the file path → download, or restore in place. No confirmation ceremony; this touches nothing else.

T1 — One module

Vibe Backup → **Restore** → choose the date → module restore. You will type the module's name to confirm, because this **replaces the module's current data** with the snapshot.

What happens automatically: the snapshot is integrity-verified (nothing restores if the key material and data came from different moments), the module's databases are rolled back, its post-restore hook runs, and you get a checklist of external re-connections (Stripe, Plaid, and so on).

If the console warns that **restored key material differs from the module's current environment**: update the module's env to the snapshot's values (shown in the warning) and restart the module — otherwise the restored data cannot decrypt.

T2 — Everything (appliance dead, encrypted, stolen, flooded)

Do not troubleshoot the dead box. You need exactly two things:

1. The **printed Recovery Kit** from the safe.

2. Any machine with a **fresh Ubuntu** install and internet.

Run:

```
curl -fsSL https://get.kisaes.com/restore | sudo bash
```

Scan the kit's QR code when prompted (or type the bucket, restore key, and passphrase). Pick the backup date. Everything else is automatic: Docker and restic install, the snapshot restores, its integrity is verified **before** anything is used, the database comes up on the exact image version the backup was taken from, and every database is restored into it. Budget: under an hour, most of it download time.

The script ends with the re-connection checklist and pointers for re-running the Vibe installer against the restored state.

If integrity verification fails, the script refuses to continue. Pick an earlier snapshot. Do not force it — a snapshot that fails pairing verification can restore data that looks fine and cannot be decrypted.

When to call support

Support's disaster-recovery line exists for: appliance unrecoverable, confirmed data loss, or ransomware — after the T2 path has been tried. "The restore worked and now I need to reconnect QuickBooks" is the checklist, not a disaster.